VIRTUALEXPERT.NET

The Customer Support Client Kit

Install an FAQ built from past emails, drafted replies, a daily queue sort, a feedback report and new-customer welcomes for a client

DENISE CULLOM

Before you start

Small businesses answer the same twenty questions over and over, usually from the owner's own inbox, usually late at night. Customers wait, the owner gets tired, and the answers drift from one email to the next.

This kit sets up an AI support desk in the client's own Claude or ChatGPT account. It starts by building an FAQ from the client's real past emails, then drafts accurate replies from it, sorts what comes in each day, reports what customers keep asking about, and welcomes new customers. It comes with the pitch, numbers, intake, tests, handover and monthly care plan to sell it as a service.

What this kit installs

Agent	What it does	Runs	Saves a month
FAQ Builder	Builds the FAQ from past customer emails	Once, then monthly	One-time setup
Support Reply Agent	Drafts accurate replies from the FAQ	Hourly, business hours	8 hrs · $248
Ticket Sorter	Sorts the day's messages by urgency and type	Weekdays, 8:10am	5 hrs · $155
Feedback Theme Report	Finds what customers keep asking and complaining about	Monthly, the 1st	2.5 hrs · $135
New Customer Welcome Agent	Drafts a welcome sequence for each new customer	On demand, per new customer	4 hrs · $129

*Total for a typical small business: **about 20 hours and $667 a month**, with review time already subtracted. How the numbers are worked out is in Part 1.*

Who to sell it to

- **Owners who answer customer email themselves**, often after hours.
- **Ecommerce shops, studios, clinics, course creators and service businesses** with lots of similar questions.
- **Clients with a small support team** who want consistent answers and a clear view of the queue.

What you need before you start

- **Your own paid Claude or ChatGPT account** to practice on. Build every agent once for yourself before you install it for a client.

- **The client on their own paid plan** (about $20 a month for one person). The agents, files and connections live in the client's account, not yours, so they keep working if you part ways and the client's data never sits in your account.
- **50 to 100 past customer emails with replies**, for the FAQ. If the client has fewer, start with their help page and add to the FAQ as questions come in.

How to use this kit

1. **Part 1, Sell it:** the pitch, the savings worksheet, what to charge and a proposal email.
2. **Part 2, Intake:** the questions to ask, the access to request and the safety rules to agree in writing.
3. **Part 3, Install:** 5 agents, each with instructions to paste, files to collect, connections and a scheduled task.
4. **Part 4, Test:** the checks to run before the client sees anything.
5. **Part 5, Hand it over:** a client-facing guide and a 20-minute handover call.
6. **Part 6, Keep it running:** a weekly care checklist, a 30-day results report and what to sell next.

Every agent works in Claude or ChatGPT. Where the steps differ, both are shown. Fill in every [bracket] before you paste anything.

The one rule

Agents draft. People approve. No reply goes to a customer until a person has read it, and refunds, discounts and exceptions are always a person's decision. You can loosen this later for one agent at a time, once it has a clean record (Part 6 shows how).

Part 1: Sell it

The 30-second pitch

Script: The pitch

"You're answering the same customer questions again and again, and some of them sit for days. I can set up an AI support desk in your own account: it builds an FAQ from your own best answers, drafts a reply to every new email for you to approve, sorts the queue every morning so upset customers come first, and tells you each month what customers keep asking about. You approve every reply. Most businesses save 15 to 20 hours a month and answer faster."

Work out their numbers

Clients buy time and money, not AI. Ask how long each job takes today, then fill in this worksheet with them on the call. The figures below are for a typical small business; replace them with the client's own.

Job	Minutes by hand	Minutes to review	Times a month	Rate	Saved a month
Research and write replies	8 a reply	3 a reply	96	$31	8 hrs · $248
Sort the queue each morning	20 a day	5 a day	20	$31	5 hrs · $155
Monthly feedback review	180 a month	30 a month	1	$54	2.5 hrs · $135
Welcome new customers	30 each	5 each	10	$31	4 hrs · $129

$31 is a customer service representative ($21.53 median pay plus benefits) and $54 a market research analyst ($37.87). Rates are U.S. median pay from the Bureau of Labor Statistics (May 2025) divided by 0.70 to include benefits and payroll taxes. If the owner does the work themselves, their time is worth more, so use their number.

Savings math

Hours saved a month = (minutes by hand − minutes to review) × times a month ÷ 60

Monthly savings = hours saved × hourly rate

For this kit: about 20 hours and $667 a month. Faster first replies and fewer repeat emails usually mean fewer refunds and better reviews, but that isn't counted

What to charge

Charge for the result and the risk you take off the client's plate, not your hours. A fixed setup fee plus a monthly care plan works best: the client knows the price up front, and you get paid to keep the agents improving.

	Suggested starting range	What it covers
Setup	$600 to $1,200	FAQ built from past emails, install of all five agents, testing, handover call
Monthly care	$200 to $450 a month	FAQ updates from every ESCALATE, weekly checks, monthly feedback and results reports
Smaller start	$350 to $500	FAQ Builder plus Support Reply Agent only

These are starting points, not market rates. Set your own based on your experience, the client's size and how much the work saves them. A good test: the setup fee should pay for itself in under three months of savings.

The proposal email

Template: Proposal email

Subject: Faster, consistent answers for your customers: support setup

Hi [first name],

Thanks for walking me through [the job, e.g., answering customer emails]. From what you told me, it takes about [hours] hours a month, which costs roughly $[amount] at [rate].

Here's what I'd set up: an FAQ built from your own best past answers, and four AI agents in your own account that draft a reply to every new customer email, sort the queue each morning so upset customers come first, report what customers keep asking about each month, and draft a welcome sequence for every new customer.

Setup: $[fee], one time. Done within [5 to 10] business days of getting access.
Monthly care: $[fee] a month. I check the agents every week, fix what needs fixing, update them as your business changes, and send you a short results report each month. Cancel any time with 30 days' notice.

Everything is built in your own [Claude / ChatGPT] account, so you own it. Nothing gets sent to anyone without a person approving it first.

If that works for you, reply "yes" and I'll send the invoice and a short intake form.

[Your name]

Part 2: Intake and access

Send the intake form as soon as the client says yes. Most installs that go wrong go wrong here: missing files, the wrong account or unclear rules.

Intake questionnaire

Send these as a form or a shared document. The first five are the same for every kit.

1. Which AI tool and plan do you use, or should we start one? (Claude Pro or ChatGPT Plus is enough to start.)
2. Which email, calendar and file storage do you use? (Gmail, Outlook, Google Drive, OneDrive, Dropbox.)
3. Who on your team will review what the agents draft, and how quickly can they usually do it?
4. Describe your business in two sentences: what you sell and who buys it.
5. Share three emails or posts you wrote that sound exactly like you.
6. Where do customer messages arrive (an inbox, a helpdesk, a contact form, social messages)? Roughly how many a week?
7. Can you export or forward 50 to 100 past customer emails with your replies?
8. What are your refund, return, cancellation and rescheduling policies? Send any written versions.
9. What should always come to you personally (refunds over a certain amount, complaints, certain customers)?
10. What happens after someone buys from you, step by step? Do you send a welcome email today?
11. Who approves replies, and how fast do you want customers to hear back?

Access checklist

Ask the client to invite you, never to send you their password. Where a tool allows it, get your own login with only the access you need.

- ☐ The client's AI account: a seat on their Team plan, or a screen-share session where they log in and you drive.
- ☐ The support inbox or helpdesk connected to the client's AI account.
- ☐ Past customer emails exported to the shared folder.
- ☐ Written policies, price list and help pages in the shared folder.
- ☐ A shared folder (Google Drive or OneDrive) called "AI agents" for the reference files in Part 3.
- ☐ A written yes to the safety rules below.

Safety rules to agree in writing

Put these in your proposal or send them as a short email and ask the client to reply "agreed." They protect the client and they protect you.

Template: Safety rules

1. Agents draft; a named person approves before anything is sent, posted, paid or deleted.
2. The agents and their files live in [client]'s account. [VA name] can be removed at any time.
3. These are never pasted into an AI tool: passwords, full card or bank account numbers, Social Security or tax ID numbers, medical records, or anything a contract says to keep confidential.
4. Paid AI plans let you turn off use of your chats for training. We'll check that setting on day one.
5. No reply is sent by an agent. Refunds, discounts, exceptions and anything legal or safety-related are always a person's decision.
6. Customer names stay out of reports. Card numbers, health information and passwords that customers email in are never copied into prompts or files.

Agreed by [client name], [date].

Check the privacy setting on day one. In Claude, open **Settings** → **Privacy**; in ChatGPT, open **Settings** → **Data controls**. Turn off the option that lets the provider use chats to improve its models, if the client's plan shows one. Names of menus change often; if you can't find it, ask the assistant "Where do I turn off training on my chats?"

Part 3: Install

Every agent below is built from the same four parts: a **project** (one home for one job), **instructions** (its job description), **files** (its training binder) and, for recurring work, a **schedule**. Connected apps are the fifth part for agents that need them.

The build steps, once

In Claude: Projects → Create project → name it → paste the instructions under Instructions → upload the files → start a chat and give it one small real task. To schedule a task, type in any chat "Every weekday at 7:10am, do the following..." and approve the task Claude proposes, or create it from the Scheduled section.

In ChatGPT: New project → name it → paste the instructions in the project's settings → add the files → test it. To schedule, type "Every weekday at 7:10am, do the following..." and confirm the card, or use the Scheduled section. Two limits to plan for: Plus allows a handful of active scheduled tasks at once, and a scheduled task may not be able to read a project's uploaded files, so every task prompt in this kit is written to stand on its own.

Set scheduled times a few minutes past the hour (7:10, not 7:00) and run each task once by hand before you trust the schedule. Menus get renamed often; if a button isn't where this kit says, ask the assistant where it went.

Install order: FAQ Builder first, and don't move on until the client has settled every disagreement. Then the Support Reply Agent, then the Ticket Sorter, the Welcome Agent and, at the start of the next month, the Feedback Report.

Agent 1: FAQ Builder

Runs: Once, then monthly · **Needs:** 50 to 100 past customer emails and replies · **Install time:** 1 to 2 hours

What it does: Reads the client's past customer emails and their replies, finds the questions that come up again and again, and writes a clear FAQ from the client's own best answers. Every other agent in this kit answers only from this file.

1. Create a project called "FAQ Builder" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: FAQ Builder**
>
> You build the customer FAQ for [business], which sells [what] to [whom].
>
> From the uploaded past emails and replies: (1) group the questions customers ask into topics (orders, pricing, scheduling, returns, how-to, account); (2) for each question asked more than once, write the question in the customer's words and the best answer, taken from our past replies; (3) list questions where our past answers **disagree** with each other, so [name] can decide the right one; (4) list questions we've been asked but never answered well.
>
> Use only our own answers and policies. Never invent a policy, a price or a timeline. Mark anything you're unsure of [CHECK].

3. Upload: 50 to 100 past customer emails with the replies (export them, or forward them to a folder and save as files), plus any existing policies, price lists and help pages.

4. Connect: the support email, if you'd like the agent to read past threads directly.

Watch for: answers that disagree. Don't pick one yourself: put every disagreement in front of the client on one page and get a decision. Save the finished FAQ as "Support FAQ" and upload it to every other project in this kit.

Agent 2: Support Reply Agent

Runs: Hourly, business hours · **Needs:** the support inbox and the FAQ · **Install time:** 45 minutes

What it does: Drafts a reply to every new customer email using only the FAQ and policies, so the client (or you) edits and sends instead of writing from scratch.

1. Create a project called "Support Reply Agent" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Support Reply Agent**
>
> You draft replies to customer emails for [business]. Answer **only** from the Support FAQ, policies and product files. Our voice: [rules, e.g., warm, clear, first names, no corporate phrases].
>
> For every message: (1) work out what the customer is asking; (2) find the answer in our files; (3) draft a reply under 120 words that answers it and says what happens next.
>
> **If the answer isn't in our files,** don't guess. Write ESCALATE and say what's missing. **Always escalate:** refunds over $[amount], complaints about a person, legal or safety issues, and anyone who has written more than twice about the same thing.
>
> Never promise a date, refund, discount or exception that isn't in our policies.

3. Upload: the Support FAQ, refund or return policy, service terms, price list, and 10 good past replies.

4. Connect: the support email or helpdesk, if a connector is available.

5. Put it on a schedule:

> **Scheduled task: Support drafts · Hourly, weekdays 9am to 5pm (or daily at 8:10am for low volume)**
>
> **Job:** Draft replies to new customer emails. **Read:** unanswered emails in [support inbox or label] from the last hour. **Steps:** (1) Answer each from this FAQ: [link or paste the FAQ]. (2) Draft a reply under 120 words in the drafts folder. (3) Mark anything not covered ESCALATE, and always escalate [list]. **Deliver:** a list: customer, question, drafted or escalated. **Never** send, post, delete or change anything. If something you need is missing, say exactly what's missing and stop.

Watch for: every ESCALATE. Each one is a gap in the FAQ. Add the answer once the client gives it to you, and the agent improves on its own.

Agent 3: Ticket Sorter

Runs: Weekdays, 8:10am · **Needs:** the support inbox · **Install time:** 30 minutes

What it does: Every morning, sorts everything that came in by urgency and type, puts angry or at-risk customers at the top, and gives the client a one-screen view of the support queue.

1. Create a project called "Ticket Sorter" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Ticket Sorter**
>
> You sort the support queue for [business] each morning.
>
> For each unanswered customer message, label: **Urgency** (Today, This week, Low) and **Type** (Question, Order or booking, Billing, Complaint, Bug or problem, Sales lead, Other).
>
> **Put first:** angry or upset customers, anyone who has written more than twice, anything mentioning cancel or refund, and anything older than [2] business days.
>
> Deliver one table, most urgent first: customer, one-line summary, urgency, type, days waiting, and whether a draft exists. Then counts by type. Never reply to, label, archive or delete any email.

3. Upload: the Support FAQ (to recognize common questions) and a list of the client's biggest customers.

4. Connect: the support email or helpdesk.

5. Put it on a schedule:

> **Scheduled task: Morning queue sort · Weekdays, 8:10am**
>
> **Job:** Sort the support queue. **Read:** all unanswered customer emails in [inbox or label]. **Steps:** (1) Label each by urgency and type. (2) Put upset customers, repeat writers, cancel or refund mentions, and anything over [2] days old first. (3) Note whether a draft reply exists. **Deliver:** one table, most urgent first, then counts by type. **Never** send, post, delete or change anything. If something you need is missing, say exactly what's missing and stop.

Watch for: missed upset customers. Read the bottom of the table for the first week; sarcasm and polite anger are easy to miss.

Agent 4: Feedback Theme Report

Runs: Monthly, the 1st · **Needs:** the month's support emails, reviews or survey answers · **Install time:** 30 minutes

What it does: Once a month, reads every support message, review and survey answer and reports the top themes, what's getting better or worse, and the three changes that would cut the most support email.

1. Create a project called "Feedback Theme Report" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: Feedback Theme Report**
>
> You write the monthly customer feedback report for [business].
>
> From this month's support messages, reviews and survey answers: (1) the top 5 themes, with how many times each came up and two short quotes; (2) what changed from last month's report; (3) the questions the FAQ doesn't answer yet; (4) three specific changes (to the website, product, process or FAQ) that would cut the most support email, with the number of messages each would have prevented.
>
> Count carefully and quote exactly. Don't name customers in the report. One page.

3. Upload: last month's report, for comparison.

4. Connect: the support email, or upload an export of the month's messages and reviews.

5. Put it on a schedule:

> **Scheduled task: Monthly feedback report · Monthly, 1st, 9:10am**
>
> **Job:** Write last month's customer feedback report. **Read:** customer emails in [inbox or label] from last month, and [review or survey export location]. **Steps:** (1) Find the top 5 themes with counts and two quotes each. (2) Compare with last month's report. (3) List questions the FAQ doesn't cover. (4) Recommend three changes that would cut support email, with counts. **Deliver:** a one-page report with no customer names. **Never** send, post, delete or change anything. If something you need is missing, say exactly what's missing and stop.

Watch for: recommendations the client can't act on. Ask the agent for changes within the client's control this month.

Agent 5: New Customer Welcome Agent

Runs: On demand, per new customer · **Needs:** the new customer's details · **Install time:** 30 minutes

What it does: Drafts a short welcome sequence for each new customer: what happens next, what to expect, the answers to the questions new customers always ask, and a check-in a week later. Fewer "what happens now?" emails, and a better first impression.

1. Create a project called "New Customer Welcome Agent" in the client's account.

2. Paste these instructions:

> **Instructions: New Customer Welcome Agent**
>
> You welcome new customers for [business].
>
> When I give you a new customer's name, what they bought and anything special about them, draft three emails in our voice: (1) **Welcome** (day 0): thank them, what happens next with dates, who to contact; (2) **Getting started** (day 2): the three questions new customers always ask, answered from the FAQ; (3) **Check-in** (day 7): ask how it's going and one specific question about their experience.
>
> Each under 150 words, one clear next step each. Use only details I give you and our files. Never promise anything not in our policies.

3. Upload: the Support FAQ, the client's onboarding steps or welcome packet, and any welcome email they already send.

4. Connect: email, for drafts.

Watch for: dates. The welcome email's "what happens next" must match the client's real process. Check it against the onboarding steps with the client before the first send.

Part 4: Test before handover

Run every test in the client's account, with their real data, before the handover call. Fix and re-run anything that fails. Keep this table: it goes in your 30-day report as proof the work was checked.

Test	How to run it	Pass if
FAQ accuracy	Client reads the full FAQ	Every answer is right, or corrected before anything else is built
Replay test	Run 10 past customer emails through the reply agent and compare with what the client actually sent	At least 8 are right with light edits; the rest are ESCALATE
Trap questions	Ask for a refund over the limit, a discount, and something not in the FAQ	All three escalate; nothing is promised
Queue sort	Run the sorter on today's queue with one known upset customer in it	That customer is at the top
Welcome dates	Draft a welcome sequence for a real recent customer	Every step and date matches the client's real process
Missing information	Give an agent a task with one key fact left out	It says what's missing and stops instead of guessing
Nothing goes out	Check sent mail, posts and records after every test	Nothing was sent, posted, changed or deleted

If the same fix comes up twice, add a rule to that agent's instructions. Agents get better from written rules, not from being told off in a chat.

Part 5: Hand it over

The client guide

Copy this into a one-page document, fill it in and save it in the client's "AI agents" folder. It's the page they'll open when you're not there.

> **Client guide: Your customer support agents**
>
> **What's running:** draft replies to new customer emails every hour during business hours, a sorted queue every weekday at 8:10am, a feedback report on the 1st of each month, and a Welcome project for new customers.
>
> **Your daily routine (about 20 minutes a day):** open the morning queue and deal with the top of it first. Open your drafts folder and send, edit or delete each reply. Answer every ESCALATE yourself and forward the answer to [VA name] so it goes in the FAQ. When someone buys, paste their details into the Welcome project.
>
> **What the agents will never do:** send, post, pay, delete or promise anything without a person approving it.
>
> **When something looks wrong:** don't fix it in the chat. Forward it to [VA name] at [email] with one line on what you expected. I'll update the instructions so it doesn't happen again.
>
> **To pause everything:** turn off the scheduled tasks under Scheduled in your AI account. Nothing else breaks.
>
> **Your monthly report** arrives on the [date] of each month with time saved, what changed and what's next.

The 20-minute handover call

Book it for the morning, when the first scheduled run has just landed, so you can walk through real output.

Minutes	What to do
0 to 3	Recap the problem in their numbers: "This was costing you about [hours] a month."
3 to 10	Open this morning's output together. Show where each agent's work lands and what to do with it.
10 to 15	Have the client approve, edit and send (or post) one item themselves while you watch.
15 to 18	Walk through the client guide: what never happens, what to do when something looks wrong, how to pause.
18 to 20	Agree the first check-in date and when the monthly report arrives.

After the call, send the client guide by email so it's in their inbox, not just their drive.

Part 6: Keep it running

Weekly care checklist (20 to 30 minutes per client)

- ☐ Every scheduled task ran this week. Open each one's history and look for skipped or failed runs.
- ☐ Connections are still signed in. Expired sign-ins are the most common reason an agent goes quiet.
- ☐ Add every answered ESCALATE to the Support FAQ and re-upload it to each project.
- ☐ Read five sent replies. Anything the client changed becomes a voice rule or an FAQ fix.
- ☐ Check that nothing in the queue is older than the agreed reply time.
- ☐ Every fix the client or reviewer made twice this week is now a written rule in the instructions.
- ☐ Reference files are current (prices, policies, team list, dates).

The 30-day results report

Send this at day 30 and every month after. It's the single best way to keep a care plan: clients cancel what they can't see.

> **Prompt: Monthly results report**
>
> Write a one-page monthly results report for [client], whose customer support agents I set up and maintain. Use a friendly, plain tone.
>
> Here's what happened this month: [paste counts, e.g., emails received, replies drafted, sent with light edits, escalations, average days waiting, new FAQ entries, top theme]. Here's what I changed or fixed: [list]. The client's time per task before was [minutes] and is now about [minutes].
>
> Include: (1) one headline sentence with hours and dollars saved this month, using a rate of $[rate]/hour; (2) a short table of each agent, what it handled and time saved; (3) what I improved; (4) one recommendation for next month, with its estimated savings. Don't invent numbers I didn't give you. Under 300 words.

Earn autonomy in stages

After a month with few edits, some clients let a person send agent drafts for the simplest questions (opening hours, how to log in) without a second reviewer. Keep two-person review for refunds, complaints and anything about money. Write the change into the instructions and the client guide, and agree it with the client by email first.

What to sell next

Support tells you what customers want, which is the best content there is. Sell the **Social Content Kit** to turn the feedback themes into posts. If support email is mixed into the owner's main inbox, sell the **Inbox & Calendar Kit**.

The other client kits

This kit is one of four Done-for-You Client Kits for VAs: **Inbox & Calendar**, **Social Content**, **Bookkeeping Prep** and **Customer Support**. Each one follows the same six parts, so once you've installed one, the next goes faster. Get the others at **virtualexpert.net/kits**.

Want help with your first install, or new workflows every month? The **AI VA Lab** membership adds a new client-ready workflow every month and a live Q&A where you can bring a client situation and get it solved: **virtualexpert.net/membership**.